

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Phase 4: Project Planning Phase

4.1 Project Scope

The scope of this project is to design, implement, and validate an automated workflow using ServiceNow Flow Designer for the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. The solution covers the end-to-end fulfilment of a standard laptop service catalog request, from order placement and approval through to the automatic generation and assignment of a configuration task to the Hardware team.

In scope:

- Creation of a Flow ("Standard Laptop Task") triggered by a Service Catalog request, which automatically creates a Catalog Task upon approval of the requested item.
- Automatic population of task fields, including short description ("Laptop needs to Configured"), description, assignment group (Hardware), and approval state (Approved).
- Association of the Flow with the Standard Laptop catalog item via the Process Engine.
- End-to-end validation through the Service Catalog, including order placement, approval, and verification of the generated Catalog Task (e.g., SCTASK0010001).

Out of scope:

- Procurement of non-standard or customised hardware items.
- Vendor management, purchase order generation, and asset inventory reconciliation.
- Automation of approvals themselves; the project consumes the existing approval outcome as a trigger condition.

4.2 Milestones and Deliverables

The project is organised into three implementation milestones, each culminating in a verifiable deliverable:

Milestone	Key Activities	Deliverable
Milestone 1: Flow Creation	Create and activate the "Standard Laptop Task" flow in Flow Designer with a Service Catalog trigger and a Create Catalog Task action.	Active flow that generates a configuration task on the requested item.
Milestone 2: Flow Assignment	Attach the flow to the Standard Laptop catalog item under Process Engine (Maintain Items).	Catalog item configured to execute the flow on order.
Milestone 3: Service Catalog Validation	Place a Standard Laptop order, complete approval, and verify the resulting Catalog Task record.	Approved request (REQ) and catalog task (SCTASK) demonstrating the automated workflow.

4.3 Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Project Lead / IT Procurement Team	Defines requirements and user story; validates business outcomes; coordinates UAT.
ServiceNow Developer (Flow Designer)	Builds, configures, and activates the flow; attaches it to the catalog item; troubleshoots execution issues.
Hardware Team (Assignment Group)	Receives and fulfils the automatically generated configuration tasks.
Approver	Reviews and approves the service request, triggering downstream task creation.

4.4 Risk Assessment and Mitigation

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Flow not triggered after approval	Configuration task never created; manual follow-up required	Verify trigger conditions and flow activation state; test with a sample order before release.
Incorrect assignment group mapping	Task routed to the wrong team; delayed configuration	Confirm the "Hardware" assignment group reference and validate field values in the Create Catalog Task action.
Conflicting process engines on the catalog item	Dual automation causing duplicate tasks	Remove existing workflows/automations on the Process Engine tab before attaching the flow.
Insufficient permissions for run-as user	Flow execution errors at runtime	Configure the flow to run as "System user" and validate privileges on sc_task creation.

4.5 Tools and Technologies

- ServiceNow Platform (Global application scope) — hosting environment.
- Flow Designer (Process Automation) — flow authoring, triggers, and actions.
- Service Catalog — Standard Laptop catalog item, ordering, and approvals.
- Catalog Task [sc_task] table — automated task records for hardware configuration.